04-20 第一篇

The Mystery of Whale Songs

Whales are among the largest and most amazing creatures in the ocean. Besides their huge size, they are famous for something else—their songs. [1] These sounds can travel hundreds of kilometers underwater. Scientists have been studying whale songs for decades, but many questions about why and how whales sing still remain unanswered. Each whale species has its own style of song, and some songs can last for more than 20 minutes.

Male humpback whales（座头鲸） are especially known for their long and complex songs. [2] They repeat certain patterns over and over, and they change their songs over time. In fact, all the males in one area often sing a similar tune, but the songs evolve from year to year. Researchers believe these songs may help males attract mates or communicate with other whales in the group. The deeper and longer the song, the more impressive it might seem to listeners.

Why can whale songs travel so far? Sound moves about four times faster in water than in air. [3] Water carries sound well, especially in the deep ocean where there are fewer obstacles. Whales use low-frequency（低频的） sounds that can travel farther than high-pitched ones. This helps them stay in touch with family members or find partners even when they are miles apart. For whales, singing is a way to "see" their world in the dark, deep sea.

However, whale songs are facing a new problem. [4] Ships, oil drills, and sonar（声呐） create a lot of noise in the ocean. This "noise pollution" can make it harder for whales to hear each other. Some scientists worry that whales might have to sing louder or change their songs to be heard. In worse cases, loud human noise could confuse whales and lead them into dangerous areas. Protecting the quiet of the ocean is becoming more important for whale survival.

[5] From their beauty to their mystery, whale songs remind us how little we know about the deep sea. By learning more about these amazing sounds, we can better protect whales and the oceans they call home. The next time you hear about whale songs, remember: they are not just music—they are a window into a hidden world.

选项

A. In short, whale songs are a gift of nature that we are only beginning to understand. B. Whales produce sounds that humans can hear, but some of their calls are too low for our ears. C. That is why many countries are working to reduce ocean noise and create quiet zones for whales. D. They sing the longest and most varied songs of any animal on

Earth. E. In other words, the ocean is like a highway for sound, and whales use it to send messages. F. Some studies suggest that whale songs may even help them navigate and find food.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] B [2] D [3] E [4] C [5] A

深度解析

- **[1] B**：
  - **线索**：引出鲸鱼歌声的特点与科学家研究背景。空前说明"whales are famous for their songs"，空后描述"These sounds can travel hundreds of kilometers underwater...Scientists have been studying...many questions still remain...Each whale species has its own style"。B选项"Whales produce sounds that humans can hear, but some of their calls are too low for our ears"（鲸鱼发出的声音人类能听到，但有些叫声对我们来说频率太低）中"produce sounds"承接空前"songs"，"humans can hear...too low for our ears"自然引出空后"Scientists have been studying...many questions remain"的研究动机，衔接顺畅。
- **[2] D**：
  - **线索**：具体介绍座头鲸歌声的特点。空前描述"Male humpback whales are especially known for their long and complex songs"，空后详述"They repeat certain patterns...change their songs over time...all males in one area sing a similar tune...evolve from year to year"。D选项"They sing the longest and most varied songs of any animal on Earth"（它们唱的是地球上任何动物中最长、最多样的歌）中"They"指代humpback whales，"longest and most varied"与空后"long and complex...repeat patterns...change...evolve"完美呼应，衔接自然。
- **[3] E**：
  - **线索**：解释鲸鱼歌声为何能传播很远。空前提出"Why can whale songs travel so far? Sound moves about four times faster in water...Water carries sound well"，空后说明"Whales use low-frequency sounds that can travel farther...helps them stay in touch...miles apart...singing is a way to 'see' their world"。E选项"In other words, the ocean is like a highway for sound, and whales use it to send messages"（换言之，海洋就像声音的高速公路，鲸鱼用它来传递信息）中"In other words"承接空前对声音在水中传播的解释，"highway for sound...send messages"与空后"stay in touch...find partners...way to 'see' their world"呼应，逻辑紧密。
- **[4] C**：

- **线索**：海洋噪音问题与应对措施。空前描述"Ships, oil drills, and sonar create a lot of noise...noise pollution can make it harder for whales to hear...might have to sing louder...loud human noise could confuse whales...dangerous areas"，空后呼吁"Protecting the quiet of the ocean is becoming more important"。C选项"That is why many countries are working to reduce ocean noise and create quiet zones for whales"（因此许多国家正在努力减少海洋噪音并为鲸鱼创建安静区域）中"That is why"承接空前问题，"reduce ocean noise...quiet zones"与空后"Protecting the quiet"精准对应，衔接得当。

- **[5] A**：
  - **线索**：全文收束与升华。空[5]位于结尾段段首，空后列举"From their beauty to their mystery...how little we know...better protect whales and the oceans...not just music—they are a window into a hidden world"。A选项"In short, whale songs are a gift of nature that we are only beginning to understand"（简言之，鲸鱼歌声是大自然的馈赠，我们才刚刚开始理解）用"In short"总结全文，"gift of nature...only beginning to understand"与空后"how little we know...window into a hidden world"形成呼应，收束精准。

- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. Some studies suggest that whale songs may even help them navigate and find food.**：涉及鲸鱼歌声的功能，易被误填[2]或[3]。但空[2]讨论的是座头鲸歌声的"length, variety, patterns, evolution"等特征，F的"navigate and find food"与空后"attract mates or communicate"功能不同；空[3]讨论声音传播的物理原理，F的"navigate and find food"与"sound travels far...stay in touch"焦点不一致。F属"主题相关但功能与上下文焦点错位"型干扰。